Engineering *Digest*

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THIS WEEK'S BRIEFING

Node 26

Long-term support enters testing on Tuesday — three-year support, native Temporal API, V8 14.6, and an Undici jump that meaningfully changes HTTP performance.

IN THIS ISSUE

Node.js 26 ships with Temporal, V8 14.6, faster Undici
UK fintech funding rebound — Q1 up 32% year-on-year
Outside In: Cloudflare on the .de DNSSEC outage
cPanel CVE-2026-41940 — 44k IPs in active exploitation
Five recommendations for platform teams in 2026
In Practice, Platform Updates & On the Radar

FOREWORD

A quiet week on the AI front, but a noisy one elsewhere. Node 26 lands as the first LTS line to bake Temporal into the standard library — a reminder that long-running language work still ships even when the headlines are about agents. Underneath, two stories worth pairing: a cPanel zero-day with 44,000 IPs already drawn into a Mirai-Sorry hybrid, and a UK fintech market that just posted its strongest quarter since 2023. Read them together — capital flowing in, attack surface flowing wider.

PRIORITY 0 — ONGOING

AWS Middle East recovery — Day 68 MULTI-MONTH

May 1	AWS confirms ME-CENTRAL-1 and ME-SOUTH-1 recovery now expected to take several months; billing remains suspended; customers urged to migrate accessible workloads.
Apr 30	Health Dashboard updated: regions described as "unable to provide stable support" with strong recommendation to restore from remote backups.

Mar 1 Original drone-strike incident at UAE datacentre; two of three availability zones impaired.

No change in the recovery timeline this week. Latest AWS guidance →

QUOTE OF THE WEEK

"The cat is out of the bag when it comes to AI. They're likely damned if they do — with increased pressure to show its impact — and damned if they don't."

— LeadDev, Five uncomfortable predictions for engineering leaders in 2026

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

Six stories in sixty seconds

Action required

Security **cPanel CVE-2026-41940 in active exploitation.** A critical authenticated RCE chain in cPanel/WHM is being weaponised by a Mirai-Sorry hybrid; roughly 44,000 IPs are already implicated. Audit any managed-hosting estate this week. *The Hacker News*

Cloud **AWS ME regions: months, not weeks.** AWS is now telling customers ME-CENTRAL-1 and ME-SOUTH-1 recovery will take "several months" and to plan permanent migrations rather than wait. *Gigazine*

Worth knowing

Runtime **Node.js 26 ships May 5; LTS in October.** Standard-library Temporal, V8 14.6, Undici 8 with notable HTTP throughput gains, and TypeScript erasable-syntax support out of the box. *nodejs.org*

Fintech **UK fintech funding up 32% year-on-year.** Q1 2026 deal value rebounds; Allica Bank closes a $155m Series, and forecasters now project full-year growth around 26%. *FinTech Global*

DNS **.de TLD outage from broken DNSSEC.** DENIC published broken DNSSEC signatures on May 5; serve-stale on resolvers cushioned the impact, but millions of German domains briefly went unreachable. *Cloudflare blog*

Watching

AI **Pragmatic Engineer's 900-engineer survey lands.** 75% of respondents now do more than half of their software work with AI; the report segments engineers into "builders, shippers, coasters" — useful framing for calibration season. *The Pragmatic Engineer*

Security **Linux kernel privilege-escalation patched at scale.** Cloudflare confirms its global fleet is fully mitigated against the latest Linux kernel CVE; expect detection rules and CIS guidance to follow this week. *Cloudflare*

PLATFORMS & RUNTIMES

Node.js 26 ships with Temporal, V8 14.6 and a noticeably faster Undici

26	14.6	8.0	36 mo
Node major version	V8 engine version	Undici release	LTS support window

What actually changed

Tuesday's Node.js 26 release is the first major line to land the JavaScript Temporal API in the standard library, removing one of the most common third-party dependencies in production estates. Internally, the runtime now ships V8 14.6, an updated Undici 8 HTTP client with measurable throughput gains for keep-alive workloads, and built-in support for TypeScript erasable syntax — meaning many service codebases can drop a separate compile step for type-only annotations.

Permissions Model exits experimental status, the test runner gains coverage merging across processes, and several long-deprecated APIs have been removed for good. That last point matters more than usual: this is the line that becomes the next Active LTS in October, so the deprecation list is the rough shape of what every Node service in production will need to be clean of by Q4.

> *"This is the line that becomes Active LTS in October — the deprecation list is, effectively, your Q4 readiness backlog."*
>
> — Editorial framing

What this means for engineering leadership

Three practical consequences. First, the LTS window extends to roughly three years, which lengthens the planning runway for teams still on Node 20 — but only if they upgrade before the October cutover. Second, native Temporal eliminates a long list of date-handling patches and shims that have

accumulated across most server fleets; expect to see PRs that strip date-fns or moment-timezone in dependency-update branches over the next month. Third, the Undici 8 throughput change is large enough that any service heavily reliant on outbound HTTP (payments, downstream APIs, SaaS integrations) should re-baseline its p95 latency rather than assume the upgrade is neutral.

Adoption signal

Major LTS cutovers historically take six to nine months to penetrate enterprise estates. The presence of Temporal in the standard library is the kind of feature that pulls migrations forward — it removes a dependency rather than adds one, which is unusual.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

→ Node 26 ships now; Active LTS designation arrives in October — plan upgrade work for the next two quarters.

→ Standard-library Temporal will quietly retire several common date-handling dependencies.

→ Undici 8 is the upgrade most likely to change observed latency; re-baseline rather than assume parity.

→ Permissions Model leaving experimental opens a path for tighter runtime sandboxing in regulated environments.

Sources: nodejs.org — Node.js 26 release notes (May 5, 2026)

QUICK TAKES

Two stories worth knowing

Security

44,000

IPs implicated in active exploitation

cPanel CVE-2026-41940 turns into a Mirai-Sorry hybrid

The May 2 disclosure of CVE-2026-41940 — a critical authenticated remote-code-execution chain in cPanel/WHM — has already moved from advisory to mass exploitation. Researchers tracking telemetry put roughly 44,000 IPs in the

UK Fintech

+32%

UK fintech deal value, Q1 2026 vs Q1 2025

UK fintech funding posts its strongest quarter since 2023

Q1 2026 closed up roughly 32% year-on-year by deal value, with the lift driven primarily by deals over $100m rather than seed-stage volume. Allica Bank's $155m Series — closed during the quarter — is the headline raise, and forecasters now expect full-year UK

active campaign, with payloads combining Mirai-style lateral spread with Sorry ransomware components. Managed-hosting estates with shared cPanel infrastructure are the most exposed; banks and fintechs that lean on white-label hosting partners should treat this as a third-party dependency question this week, not just an internal patching exercise.

The takeaway: A control-plane vulnerability in shared hosting infrastructure becomes a third-party-risk conversation the moment exploitation goes public.

Sources: The Hacker News

fintech funding to grow around 26% on 2025. The signal worth reading is composition: capital is concentrating in scale-ups with regulated revenue, not in early-stage experimentation. For engineering leadership in established UK fintechs, that translates into a more competitive market for senior platform and security talent than Q4 suggested.

The takeaway: Funding is rotating toward later-stage UK fintechs — expect tougher hiring conditions for senior platform, security, and risk engineering roles into the summer.

Sources: FinTech Global, FinTech Futures

75%

share of Pragmatic Engineer survey respondents who now do more than half their software engineering work with AI tools.

OTHER NEWS THIS WEEK

In Brief

OutSystems' agentic AI study finds 96% of developers and 94% of IT leaders worry about AI-driven sprawl — even as low-code agentic platforms ship into production. *BusinessWire*

DORA's latest platform-engineering guidance frames AI as an "amplifier" of existing capabilities, not a substitute for them; the framework now explicitly couples AI adoption to baseline DORA metric maturity. *dora.dev*

Pragmatic Engineer publishes its 900-respondent AI tooling survey, segmenting engineers into builders, shippers and coasters and noting that managers are now using AI agents as often as staff-plus engineers. *The Pragmatic Engineer*

Cloudflare's 2026 Threat Report flags hyper-volumetric DDoS and over-privileged SaaS integrations as the two fastest-growing attack vectors, with a 31.4 Tbps DDoS baseline now considered routine. *Cloudflare*

incident.io publishes its 2026 on-call best-practice guide, centred on rotation models, escalation depth and the

cost of coordination overhead during incidents. *incident.io*

PLATFORM UPDATES

At a Glance

Status	Platform	What Changed
●	**Node.js**	v26.0.0 released; Temporal in stdlib, V8 14.6, Undici 8, Permissions Model GA, TypeScript erasable syntax built in.
●	**cPanel**	CVE-2026-41940 (critical authenticated RCE) under active exploitation; emergency patch advised for any cPanel/WHM estate.
●	**Cloudflare**	Workers panic/abort recovery via wasm-bindgen now resilient; .de TLD DNSSEC outage absorbed via serve-stale.
●	**AWS**	ME-CENTRAL-1 and ME-SOUTH-1 recovery officially "several months"; billing suspended for affected accounts.
●	**Linux kernel**	Privilege-escalation CVE patched across major distributions; Cloudflare confirms global fleet mitigated.
●	**DORA**	Updated platform-engineering capability guidance: AI positioned as amplifier, baseline metric maturity now a prerequisite.

IN PRACTICE

Performance cycle — calibration & rating conversations

How to actually decide a performance rating

Camille Fournier · Spicy Takes, late 2025 · Read the full piece

Calibration season is upon us, and Camille Fournier's framework is the cleanest place to start. Her central claim: there is no algorithm that produces a fair performance rating. The job is to combine three things — tiered goals (must-achieve, stretch, moonshot), role-specific attributes from the ladder, and your own honest judgement — and then be willing to defend the result in calibration without flinching.

The piece reads as a working manager's checklist rather than a process document. She is direct about the trap most managers fall into: hiding behind data when the data is thin, or hiding behind gut feel when the data exists. The discipline is reconciling the two, and noticing when they disagree, because that disagreement is usually where bias lives.

> *No perfect algorithm exists for rating people, and managers must reconcile objective data with their gut reactions to uncover hidden biases.*

What's transferable: she frames calibration as a debate you have to be ready to win on the merits — which means starting early, writing down expectations before the cycle begins, and being precise about the difference between "exceeded" and "met". For UK and ME engineering leaders heading into year-end performance work this month, that preparation window is now.

WHY THIS MATTERS THIS WEEK

Most calibration disagreements come down to one of two things: thin evidence, or unwritten expectations. Both are easier to fix in the week before the cycle than during it.

THE LEADERSHIP READ

Five recommendations for platform teams in 2026

Platform engineering's 2026 industry report is one of the more useful pieces of the year, partly because it stops asking what platform engineering is and starts asking what good looks like. The headline gap: 94% of teams view AI as critical to platform engineering's future, but most have not yet mastered the fundamentals that make AI integration pay off.

Where the report is sharpest

The first recommendation — adopt platform-as-a-product with dedicated leadership — is the one most engineering organisations will recognise in their own gaps. Only 36.6% of respondents have dedicated Platform Product Managers; 38% are still relying on engineers with a "distributed product mindset". The report's verdict on that distributed model is unusually direct: it once looked like best practice, and now it isn't.

> *Engineers with a product mindset bring valuable perspective, but they lack the bandwidth and authority to drive platform evolution strategically.*
>
> — PlatformEngineering.org, 2026 industry report

The other four recommendations track familiar themes — measurement maturity (down from 45% to 29.6% of teams who don't measure at all), AI literacy as mandatory rather than optional, voluntary adoption over mandate, and tighter cost-to-value tracking. What makes the piece worth reading in full is the data underneath each: 89% of platform engineers use AI daily, but mostly for tactical code

generation and documentation, not embedded into platform workflows. That gap between individual usage and platform leverage is the work for the rest of 2026.

Read the full article: platformengineering.org →

This could be worth talking about: *If your platform team had a dedicated Platform Product Manager today, which roadmap decision would they have made differently in the last six months — and is that a hire worth funding before year-end?*

OUTSIDE IN

Cloudflare on the .de TLD outage and the case for serve-stale

May 5	.de	Millions	1.1.1.1
DENIC publishes broken signatures	TLD affected	domains briefly unreachable	resolver telemetry source

The incident, briefly

On May 5, DENIC — the registry for the .de top-level domain — published broken DNSSEC signatures for an entire zone. Resolvers that strictly enforce DNSSEC validation, as they should, started rejecting otherwise-healthy responses for millions of German domains. Cloudflare's write-up walks through what 1.1.1.1 telemetry saw, why the visible blast radius was smaller than the underlying breakage, and how serve-stale behaviour absorbed most of the user-facing impact.

> The honest admission worth pulling out: serve-stale is the kind of resilience pattern that looks defensive and slightly grubby in good times, and earns its keep maybe twice a year — but when it earns it, it earns it for an entire country.

What's transferable

Two things land for engineering leaders outside the DNS world. First, the incident is a clean argument for "graceful degradation as a deliberate platform investment" — not a fallback your team apologises for, but a capability you fund. Second, the post is a model of how to write up an incident you weren't responsible for: it explains what your platform did, names the upstream cause without scoring points, and surfaces a transferable lesson rather than reading as a lap of honour.

The takeaway: Resilience patterns that look ugly during normal operation are exactly the ones worth defending in design review — DNSSEC validation done strictly is correct, and serve-stale is what makes it survivable.

Read the full post: blog.cloudflare.com →

ON THE RADAR

Coming Up

MAY 14 — **LeadDev webinar — engineering leadership in the age of agents** — practical session on workflow design and team operating models around agentic tools.

MAY 27 — **LeadDev panel — measuring platform engineering ROI** — discussion centred on the metric maturity gap surfaced in this week's PlatformEngineering.org report.

JUN 02 — **LeadDev London 2026 (Jun 2–3)** — Europe's largest concentration of engineering leaders; in-person agenda confirmed.

OCT TBC — **Node.js 26 enters Active LTS** — the deprecation list becomes the readiness backlog for any production estate still on 20.

RECOMMENDED READING

This Week's Links

Node.js 26.0.0 release notes	nodejs.org
Five key recommendations for platform teams in 2026	platformengineering.org
The impact of AI on software engineers in 2026	pragmaticengineer.com
Introducing the 2026 Cloudflare Threat Report	blog.cloudflare.com
On-call best practices: handoffs, schedules, and alert fatigue	incident.io
Camille Fournier on performance rating frameworks	skamille.spicytakes.org

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